



△ Boeing 247 1933

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 550 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 200 mph (322 km/h)

This very advanced machine for its time incorporated many modern features, including an all-metal semimonocoque fuselage and cantilever wing, retractable undercarriage, autopilot, variable pitch propellers, and a deicing system. It was the first twin-engine transport capable of sustained flight on one engine, and was faster than most fighters of the time.



△ de Havilland DH91 Albatross 1938

Origin UK

Engine 4 x 525 hp de Havilland Gipsy 12 air-cooled inverted V12

Top speed 225 mph (362 km/h)

Originally designed as a long-range mailplane, of the seven aircraft built five were constructed as passenger aircraft. Two notable features are that it was made from a ply-and-balsa sandwich (which de Havilland would use to great effect on its famous Mosquito fighter-bomber) and that the air-cooled engines had reverse-flow cowlings.

△ de Havilland DH89 Dragon Rapide 6 1934

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 200 hp de Havilland Gipsy 6 air-cooled inverted in-line 6

Top speed 157 mph (254 km/h)

Possibly the best British short-haul aircraft of the 1930s, the Dragon Rapide was a rugged and reliable aircraft that replaced the earlier DH84 Dragon. The biplane configuration ensured that takeoff and landing speeds were low, making it ideal for operating from small grass runways.



▷ de Havilland DH95 Flamingo 1939

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 930 hp Bristol Perseus air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 239 mph (385 km/h)

The first all-metal aircraft built by de Havilland, the Flamingo was intended to compete with contemporary American machines, such as the Lockheed Electra and Douglas DC-3. Fitted with slotted flaps, variable pitch propellers, and a retractable undercarriage, it performed well, but only 14 were built.



▷ Douglas DC-2 1934

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 730 hp Wright Cyclone air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 210 mph (338 km/h)

The DC-2 entered service with TWA in 1934. The Dutch airline KLM entered one in the MacRobertson air race, between London and Melbourne the same year. Astonishingly, it came second, being beaten only by the specially built DH88 racer.



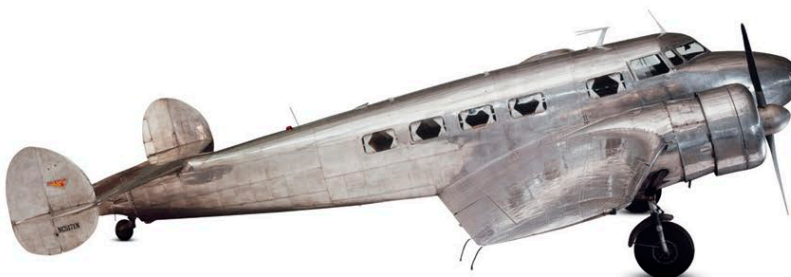
△ Lockheed Model 10 Electra 1934

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 450 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp Junior air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 202 mph (325 km/h)

Probably best known as the type of aircraft in which famous aviatrix Amelia Earhart disappeared, the Electra was Lockheed's first all-metal design. Much of the design work was done by a young student, Clarence Johnson, who would later lead Lockheed's famous "Skunk Works."



△ Beechcraft Model 18 1937

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 450 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 264 mph (424 km/h)

Known universally as the "Twin Beech," the Model 18 was an extremely successful design with over 9,000 being built over a very long production run. Available with a variety of different engines later in trigear form, several hundred remain airworthy.

